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21LEM202T — Unit 1, Session 3, SLO 1

Part B — In-Class Activity

Activity 1 — The Dialogue Within

Pick one desire/expectation you have. Compare it with what you really want to be (your natural acceptance), and note whether they are in harmony or contradiction.

What I am (a desire / expectation)	What I really want to be (natural acceptance)	In harmony or contradiction? → happiness/unhappiness
I want to earn a lot of money quickly	**To live a fulfilling and peaceful life with meaningful relationships**	**Contradiction → unhappiness**
I expect my friend to always agree with me	**To be a supportive and understanding person**	**Contradiction → unhappiness**

Activity 2 — Natural Acceptance vs Liking

For each example, write what you LIKE and the deeper thing you NATURALLY ACCEPT.

Example	I like...	I naturally accept...
Waking early or late	**Waking late on weekends**	**Waking early enough to have a calm, productive day**
Playing with toys / travelling the world	**Playing video games**	**Exploring new places and learning about different cultures**
Food from a particular restaurant	**Pizza from a specific chain**	**Eating nutritious food that keeps me healthy**

Activity 3 — Content of Self-exploration

Answer for yourself (Yes / No):

- Do I desire happiness? Do I desire prosperity? Do I desire the continuity of both?
- If the continuity of happiness and prosperity were ensured, what else would I desire?
- Do I desire happiness? **Yes**
- Do I desire prosperity? **Yes**
- Do I desire the continuity of both? **Yes**
- If the continuity of happiness and prosperity were ensured, what else would I desire? **I would desire to help others achieve the same, and to explore my full potential in creativity, service, and relationships.**

Activity 4 — Which Process is Naturally Acceptable to You?

Tick one and say why:

- Self-exploration / self-verification on your own right, leading to understanding in yourself, OR
- A process of do's and don'ts, assuming what is said without verification.

I tick **Self-exploration / self-verification on your own right, leading to understanding in yourself**. Because it allows me to discover what is true for me through my own reasoning and experience, rather than blindly following rules, which leads to genuine and lasting understanding.

Part C — Long-Answer Questions

Q1. Explain self-exploration as "the dialogue within." Between which two things does it take place, and what is the outcome when they are in harmony and when in contradiction?

Self-exploration as "the dialogue within" refers to the internal conversation between my **'self' (what I really am)** and my **'self-image' (what I think I am)**. When they are in harmony, the outcome is **clarity, confidence, and a feeling of being in tune with my natural acceptance**. When they are in contradiction, the outcome is **confusion, conflict, and a sense of being unsettled or unhappy**.

Q2. What is natural acceptance? List its characteristics.

Natural acceptance is the **innate, unconditional, and unchanging approval or acceptance of what is right and true within oneself, without any external pressure or condition**. Its characteristics are:

1. It is **innate** – present in every human being from birth.
2. It is **unconditional** – not dependent on any external factor or reward.
3. It is **unchanging** – it does not vary with time, place, or situation.
4. It is **self-evident** – it does not require proof or external validation.
5. It is **the basis for right understanding and harmony**.

Q3. Describe the content and the process of self-exploration.

The **content** of self-exploration is **the exploration of my own desires, thoughts, beliefs, and values** to understand what is truly fulfilling and what is not. The **process** involves **a continuous dialogue within myself** where I question my assumptions, verify them through my own experience and natural acceptance, and move towards a state of harmony between my 'self' and my 'self-image'. It is not a one-time activity but an ongoing journey of self-discovery and self-verification.